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TO: Medford City Council
FROM: Councilor Justin Tseng
DATE: May 20, 2026
RE: Proposed Amendments to the Do Not Knock Registry Ordinance

Dear Fellow Councilors,

Upon resident outreach, I am proposing an amendment to Section 14-315 of our Code of Ordinances, which governs the City's Do Not Knock Registry. The registry allows residents to opt out of door-to-door solicitation by enrolling their address with the City Clerk — a protection many residents don't know exists, and one that has real gaps in its current form. As written, the ordinance only distributes the registry to solicitors at the time they receive their license, meaning residents who register later receive no protection from already-licensed operators. It also leaves ambiguous whether unlicensed solicitors — those operating in Medford without a license at all — are bound by the registry, and it places enforcement responsibility on individual canvassers rather than the companies that send them. This amendment closes all three gaps: requiring licensees to obtain updated registry lists monthly, explicitly extending registry protections to unlicensed solicitors, and making businesses accountable when their employees ignore a registered address.

PROPOSED AMENDMENT

Recommended language is shown underlined and in blue; I wouldn't recommend for any existing language to be deleted.

Sec. 14-315. — Do Not Knock Registry.

(a)

The city clerk shall prepare a list of addresses of those premises where the owner and/or occupant has notified the clerk that a door-to-door salesperson, hawker, peddler or any other person, including corporate or business entities, wishing to sell wares or services in all districts, in locations which are not

stationary are not permitted on the premises (hereinafter referred to as the “Do Not Knock Registry”). Notification shall be by completion of a form available at the city clerk’s office during normal business hours.

No change to subsection (a).

(b)

The city clerk shall distribute the current “Do Not Knock Registry” to a person or entity licensed under section 14-311 at the time of issuance of the license. The licensee shall not peddle, canvass, or conduct door-to-door sales at any premises identified on the then current “Do Not Knock Registry.” The city clerk shall also make the then-current Do Not Knock Registry available to all licensees on a monthly basis and shall provide the then-current registry to the chief of police or a designee on a monthly basis and upon request. The city clerk and the chief of police or their designee shall provide an updated registry to any licensee upon request. Each licensee is responsible for obtaining and consulting the most current registry before conducting any door-to-door solicitation. A licensee’s failure to obtain or consult an updated registry shall not be a defense to a violation of this section.

(c)

Any canvasser, peddler, itinerant vendor or owner or employee of a door-to-door sales enterprise who violates any provision of this section shall be:

- (1) Subject to an ordinance violation fine of \$300.00 per offense; and/or
- (2) Subject to a one-year revocation of any license issued pursuant to the within article.

(3) For purposes of subsection (c)(2), a violation committed by any canvasser, employee, or agent acting on behalf of a licensed business entity shall be attributed to that entity and shall constitute grounds for revocation of the entity’s license. It shall not be a defense that the individual canvasser rather than the entity personally committed the violation.

(d) [New subsection]

The prohibitions of this section apply to any person or entity engaged in door-to-door solicitation within the City of Medford, whether or not such person or entity has obtained a license under section 14-311. Any unlicensed person or entity that solicits at a premises listed on the Do Not Knock Registry shall be subject to the penalties set forth in subsection (c)(1) of this section for each such offense, in addition to any penalties applicable under section 14-311 for operating without a license. Lack of knowledge of the registry’s contents shall not be a defense to a violation of this section by an unlicensed person or entity.

Key: Underlined blue text = new language added by this ordinance. No existing language is deleted.

SUMMARY OF AMENDMENTS

This ordinance makes three targeted amendments to Section 14-315:

Amendment 1 — Monthly registry refresh (subsection b)

Requires the city clerk to make the updated Do Not Knock Registry available to all licensees monthly and separately requires monthly distribution to the chief of police — ensuring the Medford Police Department, who many licensees go to for such information, has the list regardless of future personnel changes. This also requires licensees to consult the current registry before canvassing and clarifies that failure to check for updates is not a defense. Note: A separate minor amendment to Section 14-316 (Enforcement) is recommended to add a parenthetical making explicit that police officers enforcing this article have access to the Do Not Knock Registry maintained by the city clerk. This can be incorporated into the same ordinance.

Amendment 2 — Employer liability for employee violations (subsection c)

Adds subsection (c)(3) making clear that a registry violation by any canvasser, employee, or agent acting on behalf of a licensed business is attributable to that business for purposes of the one-year license revocation remedy. This ensures that the revocation penalty — the most meaningful deterrent for companies — reaches the entity sending canvassers, not only the individual at the door.

Amendment 3 — Unlicensed solicitors (new subsection d)

Establishes explicitly that the Do Not Knock Registry protections apply to unlicensed solicitors. Under the existing ordinance, the registry is distributed only to licensees, leaving ambiguity about whether an unlicensed operator who never received the registry could nonetheless be cited for a registry violation. The new subsection closes that gap, imposes the \$300 per-offense fine on unlicensed registry violations, and clarifies that lack of knowledge of the registry is not a defense.